

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 787

By Capley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of William Allen Dorning of Lawrence County.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of William Allen Dorning of Lawrence County; and

WHEREAS, the retired sheriff of Lawrence County, William Dorning was an exemplary citizen and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, a native of Harvest, Alabama, William Allen Dorning was the son of Robert Irving and Clarice Steelman Dorning; and

WHEREAS, a proud military veteran, he rendered sterling service with the United States Air Force and was an esteemed member of American Legion Post 146; and

WHEREAS, a career law enforcement officer and member of the Tennessee Sheriff's Association, Chief William Dorning served with the Tennessee Highway Patrol and as a Saint Joseph Police Officer before winning election in 1994 to the post of Sheriff of Lawrence County, where he would continue to serve until 2006; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep and abiding faith, he was a member of New Prospect Baptist Church, which he served in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Chief Dorning was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, a beloved family patriarch, he was the proud father of Cindy Dorning, Christie Dorning (Donnie) White, and John (Guinn) Dorning; doting grandfather of Kelli (Chris) Gartner, Will (Jennifer) Hutton, Ben (Kelly) Hutton, Lauren White (Brian) Arrington, Luke (Julia) White, Catie Dorning (Brady) Crews, Carli Dorning (Jake) Clark, and Sophie Dorning; and loving

great-grandfather of Jack Ryan Carpentier, Alyssa Sisemore, Halle Hutton, Harper Hutton, Griffin Hutton, Bodie Hutton, Russell Hutton, Bette White, Tatum White, Beckham Arrington, Claire Arrington, Finn Crews, Liam Crews, Cole Crews, Ellie Clark, and Jolee Clark; and

WHEREAS, he will be fondly remembered but sadly mourned by his brother, Jerry (Karen) Dorning, and his sister, Janet Mick, and a host of dear friends and former colleagues; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Chief Dorning was preceded in death by his wife, Patty Hughey Dorning; his daughter, Angie Dorning Johnson; his brothers, Irving Dorning and Kenneth Ray "Ken" Dorning; and his sisters, Joan Dorning, Helen Dorning Hudson, and Sue Kinsey Boswell; and

WHEREAS, Chief William Dorning leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of William Allen Dorning, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Chief Dorning.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.